

The Birthday That Took My Breath Away

→ Aryan Kulkarni

It was my first Birthday which was being Hosted at a Pool, and I was probably 10 Years old.

For a 10-year-old, hosting a pool party was the one of the BEST things which could have happened at that point of time.

I had also learnt Swimming by attending classes just so that I could enjoy myself in the pool with my friends.

At around 11am, we all were ready to enjoy ourself in the pool, we swam for almost 2-3 hours with all Activities, played games and it was Amazing, I was very happy that I was able to Swim Nicely & Enjoy myself in the pool

After 2-3 Hours, when all were leaving the pool, a small kid removed his floating tube and went to the deep side, he was my friend's younger brother who was around 5-6 years old & Did not know Swimming. He started Screaming for help as he was drowning. I was exiting the pool when I heard the scream & jumped back in the pool to rescue him.

As I approached him, I wanted to hold his hand & take him to the sides of the pool & things would be fine, but NO! He grabbed & choked my neck instead, & since it was deep, I was trying to float myself & needed to be on the surface of the water to breathe, but the kid started choking my neck so that he wouldn't drown, & I was trying to remove his hand from my neck by lifting him to save myself & him, but he didn't leave his hand from my neck instead started pressing harder & started crying louder. Because of the intense pressure, I fainted in the pool & the next moment, when I opened my eyes, I was outside, on floor coughing out water & had seen the kid's dad who also Didn't know how to swim had jumped in the pool to save his child, but he also started drowning causing Two other uncles trying to pull him out of the water.

When it was finally time for the cake cutting, the excitement of my birthday had completely vanished.

My face had turned pale, hands shivering, crying cause of the fear and trauma of what just happened all of them in front of my Parents. later when I asked others how Did I end up being on the floor outside of the pool, they explained me that, two other friends of mine jumped to save the kid after seeing my situation there, and pushed me & him towards the side slab of the pool.

One of the most traumatic Birthday's I ever faced in my entire life, even though I was appreciated for saving the kid and my courage to do it, I had almost dead for legit 30-40 Seconds cause of No Air being supplied in my body.

What had planned to be The Most Amazing & Fun Birthday Party, turned out to be a Nightmare, it haunts me more because I was 10 years' old at that point of time, It was a childhood trauma. I didn't

go Anywhere near the pool for almost an year cause of this fear & Maintained my Distance from that kid who caused me this fear & Trauma (Funny Now).

After A year of that Incident, I did eventually start giving Courage to myself for Swimming & Now, I love Swimming, but somewhere that Incident Didn't leave my Body & Mind yet.

Looking Back at that Incident Now, I can crack jokes, narrate it in a funny manner & Make fun of it which can make others laugh as well. But at that point of my life, it was Nothing but a Pure Haunted Nightmare.

I am happy that I have grown beyond that incident, and that I can now look back at it without the same fear. But deep down, I know that some part of me is still trapped in that moment. The trauma may have faded with time, but the memory of that day still lives within my mind and lingers in my body.

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